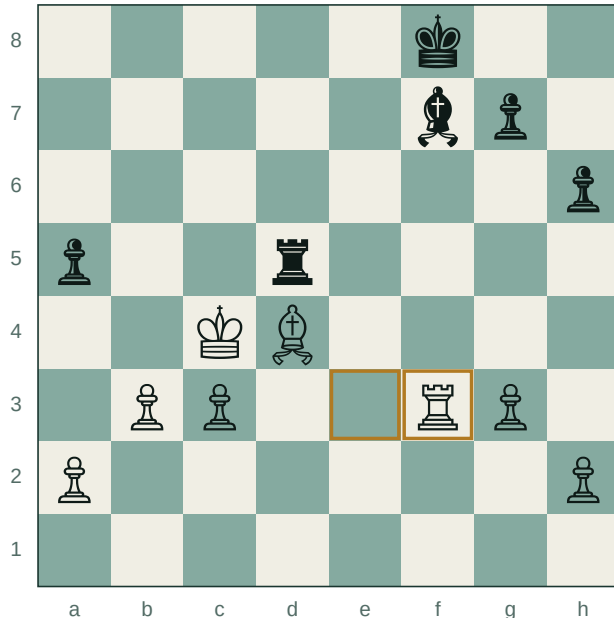


# Discovered checks: Black, move 36

Discovered checks

Black to move



Previous move: 36.Rf3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**36...Rf5+ 37. Kd3 Rxf3+**

**36...Rf5+** Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The changed line means the bishop on f7 attacks the king on c4. Recorded reply: **37.Kd3**.

**37...Rxf3+** Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on f3.

At the end, nominal material is White 8 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

## CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

## CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A discovered check opens a line toward the king by moving the blocking piece. Because check must be answered, the moving piece may gain a free tempo for another threat.

## HOW TO LOOK

Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on c4. Geometrically undefended: rook on f3. Check for tactical protection.